

painting, bird flight, and the science of hydraulics to studies of animals, the bones and muscles of the human body, and the workings of the eye. Unfortunately, all of Leonardo's efforts were in vain—the notebooks were never published in his lifetime.

Before long, the little energy Leonardo had left was consumed by the simple tasks of getting through each day. In his dying months, according to Vasari, Leonardo “set himself to study the holy Christian religion, and though he could not stand, desired to leave his bed with the help of his friends and servants to receive the Holy Sacrament.”



Francesco Melzi

Leonardo wrote his will on April 23, 1519, knowing he had little time left. Most of his art and notebooks he left to his former student and current companion, Francesco Melzi, who had served him for many years. Leonardo also left instructions for an elaborate funeral.